

The final hurdle

By this stage in the marathon search, having lost more Saturdays at ‘open for inspections’ than you have dollars to spend, you will have noticed there are different methods that vendors use to sell: auctions, private sales (sometimes called private treaties) and expressions-of-interest campaigns.

- **Auctions**

The property is sold ‘under the hammer’ in an open-market street fight for the right to sign the contract. These are public sales, in the spirit of transparency.

- **Private sales/treaties**

These require negotiation; you make an offer to the agent, who takes it to the vendor, and there is a back-and-forth to agree on the final price. Private sales are not usually time-sensitive and don’t have a deadline under which to make your offer.

- **Expressions of interest**

The agent invites you to make an offer on the property within a timeframe. There will be a deadline, usually the close of a business day at the end of the marketing campaign, commonly four weeks, by which time you must lodge an offer for it to be considered.

Vendor’s statement or disclosure statement

This is the one thing that all three methods of sale have in common. The euphoria of getting the tick of a loan approval from a bank or lender is equally matched by the nervous possibility of missing out at auction, and that can be a testing time even for those most seasoned at bidding and buying, let alone a novice. But the joy of winning that bid can become a headache of migraine proportions if, as the buyer, you didn’t do your due diligence before signing the contract of sale. This is where a vendor’s